Daily Content Intel

July 10, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, if you play football or lacrosse and your groin keeps grabbing when you plant and cut, I want to talk about the adductor. It's the muscle on the inside of your thigh that fires hard every time you decelerate, change direction, and pull your leg back under you. When it's weak, especially weak in the lengthened position, that's when it strains.

There's a systematic review and meta-analysis from 2025 on the Copenhagen adduction exercise, and here's what it found. The exercise builds large eccentric strength in the adductors, which is the exact quality that goes missing before a groin injury. And the strength gains tracked with the reps, so the athletes who did more of them got stronger.

The number that matters is about 30 reps a week for 8 weeks. That's it. You can put it in a warm-up or bolt it onto your lower body day.

Now I'll be straight with you. When they pooled every study, the drop in seasonal groin injuries didn't hit statistical significance, so I'm not going to promise you it makes you injury-proof. But low adductor strength is one of the clearest things I can measure before a groin strain, and this is the best field tool I know to build it back. I'd rather train the lever I can actually move.

So start light, one knee down, control the way down, and add reps over the weeks. Your cuts hold up better when the inside of your leg can take the load.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If you keep tweaking your groin on hard cuts, your adductors are losing the eccentric war, and there's one exercise that wins it back.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, if you play football or lacrosse and your groin keeps grabbing when you plant and cut, I want to talk about the adductor. It's the muscle on the inside of your thigh that fires hard every time you decelerate, change direction, and pull your leg back under you. When it's weak, especially weak in the lengthened position, that's when it strains.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Groin grabbing on every cut?
- 0:08 Adductors lose the ECCENTRIC war first

- 0:20 The Copenhagen Adduction Exercise
- 0:32 ~30 reps/week for 8 weeks
- 0:45 Strength gains scaled with the reps
- 0:58 Injury drop: promising, not proven yet
- 1:10 Train the lever you can move

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Groin pulls in football and lacrosse almost always trace back to one thing: adductors that can't handle load in the lengthened position. A 2025 systematic review on the Copenhagen adduction exercise found it builds large eccentric adductor strength, and the gains scaled with the reps put in. The dose that worked: about 30 reps a week for 8 weeks, easy to drop into a warm-up.

Honest note: when every study got pooled, the drop in seasonal groin injuries didn't reach statistical significance, so this isn't a guarantee. But weak adductors are one of the clearest measurable risk factors out there, and the Copenhagen is the best field tool to fix it. Train the lever you can actually move.

Start one knee down, control the lower, add reps weekly.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#lacrosse #footballtraining #groininjury #adductor #copenhagenexercise #injuryprevention #strengthandconditioning #athletictrainer #returntosport #sportsPT #speedtraining #changeofdirection

Personalize this

- Which of your NoVA football or club lacrosse athletes has the nagging groin that flares on hard cuts, and what have you already tried with them before reaching for the Copenhagen?
- How do you screen adductor strength side to side before you clear an athlete back to full cutting, without force plates?
- Where does the Copenhagen fit in your CROSS framework, warm-up prep or accessory strength, and how do you progress it for an in-season athlete who can't be sore on game day?

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12363431/ | "The Copenhagen Adduction Exercise Effect on Sport Performance and Injury Prevention: A Systematic Review With Meta■Analysis"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12363431/ | "Adduction strength adaptations were dependent on the repetitions performed"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12363431/ | "To effectively increase hip adduction strength, performing ~30 repetitions per week over 8 weeks is advised, and a higher number of repetitions may yield larger strength gains."

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12363431/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. Those heavy or explosive potentiation warm-ups everybody copies from the pros, the heavy squat before you sprint, the loaded jumps before you test, they don't work the same for everybody, and for a lot of high school athletes they can actually backfire.

There's a 2025 meta-analysis on personalized warm-ups, and it split athletes by level. The strong, high-level ones got a real jump improvement after that kind of warm-up with short and moderate rest. The lower-level athletes, though, got nothing, and after short rest they actually got a little worse. Transient inhibition. Their nervous system was still tired from the heavy thing, and there wasn't enough strength underneath it to turn that fatigue into pop.

Here's the line they drew. If your squat is roughly double your bodyweight, potentiation warm-ups can help you. If you're not there yet, that heavy primer is mostly just fatiguing you before you compete.

So for my younger and newer athletes, I keep it simple. I build the base strength first, and I keep the warm-up about getting fast and getting ready to go.

If you've got a strong senior who squats big, sure, prime him and give him 5 to 8 minutes. If you've got a sophomore who's still learning to squat, get him warm, get him moving fast, and go.

Does that make sense?

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: That explosive warm-up your athletes copied from the pros might be making the younger ones slower.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. Those heavy or explosive potentiation warm-ups everybody copies from the pros, the heavy squat before you sprint, the loaded jumps before you test, they don't work the same for everybody, and for a lot of high school athletes they can actually backfire.

There's a 2025 meta-analysis on personalized warm-ups, and it split athletes by level. The strong, high-level ones got a real jump improvement after that kind of warm-up with short and moderate rest. The lower-level athletes, though, got nothing, and after short rest they actually got a little worse. Transient inhibition. Their nervous system was still tired from the heavy thing, and there wasn't enough strength underneath it to turn that fatigue into pop.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 That pro-style explosive warm-up?
- 0:10 It can make younger athletes SLOWER
- 0:22 2025 meta-analysis: warm-ups by athlete level
- 0:34 Strong athletes: real jump gains
- 0:44 Weaker athletes: transient inhibition
- 0:55 Rule of thumb: 2x bodyweight squat
- 1:08 Build strength first, then prime

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The heavy squat before you sprint, the loaded jumps before you test, potentiation warm-ups are everywhere because the pros use them. A 2025 meta-analysis split athletes by level and found the effect flips. High-level athletes got real jump improvements after short and moderate rest. Lower-level athletes got no gain, and after short rest they actually got a little worse. That's transient inhibition: not enough strength underneath the primer to turn the fatigue into power.

The threshold they landed on was a squat around double bodyweight. Above it, priming helps and 5 to 8 minutes of rest is the window. Below it, that heavy primer is mostly just tiring the athlete out before they compete.

For younger athletes, build the base strength first and keep the warm-up about getting fast and ready. Save the fancy primers for the ones who've earned them.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#strengthandconditioning #footballtraining #lacrosse #sprintspeed #warmup #postactivationpotentiation #youthathletes #speedtraining #trackandfield #athleticdevelopment #coaching #verticaljump

Personalize this

- What does your warm-up actually look like before speed or testing days for your HS football and lacrosse athletes, and do you run the same one for a strong senior and a raw sophomore?
- Where do most of your athletes sit relative to that 2x bodyweight squat mark, and how does that change what you'd have them do before a game or a combine test?
- Have you ever watched an athlete look flat right after a heavy primer, and how do you decide when someone's earned the fancy warm-up versus when they just need to get warm and move fast? Tie it to CROSS.

Screenshots:

- title | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12711518/ | "Personalized warm-up strategies for adult athletes: a meta-analysis based on athletic level, gender, and region"
- physiology | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12711518/ | "no gains and even transient inhibition post short intervals"
- actionable | https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12711518/ | "athletes with high proficiency (squat 1RM/weight ≥2) can combine short/medium recovery intervals of HIPS warm-up to optimize vertical jump performance; athletes with low proficiency need to prioritize enhancing their basic strength"

Sources:

- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12711518/

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Neck strength and concussion risk: the 2020 HS football protocol (Rotto et al., OJSM) showed 19.8% flexion strength gains and a season-over-season concussion drop (12 → 7 → 4), but the Jan 2026 systematic review says pooled evidence is still inconclusive. Revisit when a large RCT lands, framed as durability training.
- In-season hydration and cramping for football two-a-days (heat acclimatization done as the action angle, not the scare angle).
- Iron/ferritin screening in endurance and multi-sport high school athletes as a performance limiter.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest (2026-07-10): one source, Mike T. Nelson "The greatest increase in VO2 max....ever" — heavily promotional (Flexible Meathead Cardio course launch) built on the Hickson 1977 aerobic-power study. Interesting principle (build the aerobic engine in order, VO2 max is trainable in lifters) but promo-dominant, and Nelson's cardio content was already cited 2026-07-08. Passed over as a primary angle.

- PubMed / web scan, athlete-biased terms (football, lacrosse, high school, collegiate, return to sport, in-season):
- Neck strength and concussion risk — found a fresh Jan 2026 systematic review (Postula et al., Current Sports Medicine Reports). Read it: evidence is inconclusive, "no statistically significant differences in neck strength," "further large RCTs needed." Weak teaching angle and leans toward injury-fear content, so passed over (moved to runner-up).
- Copenhagen adduction exercise for groin injury prevention — strong 2025 systematic review with meta-analysis (Quintana-Cepedal et al., Scand J Med Sci Sports). Read in full. SELECTED for Draft A.

- Post-activation potentiation / warm-up personalization — 2025 meta-analysis (Xu et al., Frontiers in Physiology) showing the effect flips by athlete level. Read in full. SELECTED for Draft B.
- Dedup: both selected primary URLs checked against cited-sources.json (last 90 days) — neither present. Clean.